

Language Study

Reading Level 3
Penmanship & Copywork
Written Narration





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Reading Level 3, Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3, Written Narration: Grade 3

About Reading Level 3

The Alveary Reading Level 3 lessons feature captivating folk tales, fairy tales, fables, and wonder tales from around the world. The Free and Treadwell Reader for this course also includes the poetry of Robert Louis Stevenson and Christina Rossetti. By this Level, readers will typically have mastered basic word decoding. They will continue to practice higher-level phonics, learn less common spelling patterns, and investigate the morphology and etymology of new words. Fluency (the ability to read text quickly, easily, and accurately) is emphasized. Grammar concepts introduced in Levels 1 and 2 will be taught in more detail and new topics will be added. The intent of the lessons is that they serve as a bridge to independent reading by providing students with the capability for becoming self-directed, insightful, thinking readers.

About Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3

Copy short sentences and write them from dictation.

About Written Narration: Grade 3

Students begin writing narrations or a part of a narration as appropriate.



Placement & Combining Tips

Reading Level 3

Students who can already read may use the stories for reading practice but focus mainly on the spelling and grammar elements, including copywork and dictation.

Prerequisite: Beginning Reading & Lang. Level 2 or appropriate skill proficiency.

Written Narration: Grade 3

Students who are not yet secure with their penmanship are not yet ready for written narration. Instead of written narrations, use the time to have students work on skills that will better support their development.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3	Reading Level 3 5 times/week 15 min	Reading Lessons: Level 3 Reading-Literature: Second Reader
3	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 5 times/week 10 min	Getty-Dubay® Italic Handwriting Book D Italics: Beautiful Handwriting for Children
3	Written Narration: Grade 3 1 time/week 10 min	

[Sample Weekly View](#)

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 3				
Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 Reading Level 3	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 Reading Level 3	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 Reading Level 3	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 Reading Level 3	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 Reading Level 3 Written Narration: Grade 3



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Reading Level 3

☐ Print on cardstock, cut apart, sort, and label all Supplementary Materials for each lesson, found in the Introduction section of the Reading Lessons Teacher Guide. This should be completed before starting lessons with students. This is a crucial step needed in order to be successfully prepared for lessons.

☐ Continue entering lists of words that follow specific spelling or sound patterns in students' Word Journals.

☐ Equip students with blank-lined journals divided into sections for Copywork, Studied Dictation, and Written Narrations.

Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3

If you are using the Getty-Dubay Italic Handwriting Series, complete half a page per day or go at student's pace.

Written Narration: Grade 3

☐ Aim to complete one written narration every week by the end of the year, but start with one every few weeks or every other week.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Language Study: Grade 3

Reading Level 3



Reading Lessons: Level 3



Reading-Literature: Second Reader

Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3



Getty-Dubay® Italic Handwriting Book D



Italics: Beautiful Handwriting for Children



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

- ∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
- ∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Reading Level 3



Letter Tiles



Tile Organizer



Business Card Paper



Whisper Phone



Printable Big Tab Divider Inserts



Card Organizer



Plastic Organizer



Letter Tile Organizer



Quick Links

Language Study: Grade 3

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Sections 3 & 8: Narration & English\)](#)

Reading Level 3

- ∞ [Alveary Reading Lesson Placement](#)
- ∞ [Literacy Development from Birth to Age 9](#)
- ∞ [Level 3 Teacher Guide](#)
- ∞ [Scholastic webpage](#)
- ∞ [Errata Page: Reading Level 3 for lessons released prior to 11/19/25](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 14: Reading Lessons\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Language Study: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ DICTATE/DEMONSTRATE

Each lesson after the first will begin with dictation of 1-2 mastered letters. Simply call out a letter that has been mastered and have the child write it from memory on the Penny Gardner lined paper. Then the teacher should model any new strokes or letters properly on a chalkboard while narrating steps.

→ VISUALIZE

The student should visualize the letter and then write it from memory on his or her smaller chalkboard (the drag on the chalk helps them “feel” the stroke).

→ PRACTICE

The student will continue practicing the letter on the chalkboard until mastered from memory. Then, slowly and carefully copy the letter on the single practice line in the lesson.

→ EVALUATE

Allow the student to self-assess before writing another copy of the letter. The student continues copying from memory until able to produce six very good copies in a row.

Only focus on 1-2 letters per day at most, and allow as long as needed for particularly difficult letters or new stroke patterns. Use extra practice paper as needed, but celebrate when able to produce these six copies within the single practice line.

→ COPY

Once students have mastered enough letters, they may use time at the end of their writing lessons to copy words from their reading lesson word lists on their Penny Gardner lesson pages. Just flip back to the first word list and start from there. Students will need gentle reminding to visualize those words as a whole and to write them from memory rather than letter by letter.

Older students may start copying interesting sentences or phrases from poems and books as they are able.

★ TEACHER TIP

Even though the Penny Gardner Italics lessons include words, it's better to skip those initially. Stick to dictating 1-2 known letters as a warm-up, and then focus on learning 1-2 new letters per lesson until the lowercase letters are mastered.

★ TEACHER TIP

Use this space in your lesson plans to note what letters your student is ready to dictate for easy reference.

★ TEACHER TIP

If students have already mastered writing words during reading lessons, then you may have them move on to copying the nursery rhymes, poetry, and quotes found in the penny garner italics book during the COPY section of the lessons.

WEEK 1 15m Reading Level 3 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ COMPLETE

Lessons 1.1-1.5 this week

WEEK 1 10m Written Narration: Grade 3 - Lesson 1

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

Complete one written narration this week (or start every other week). Make sure to write from a variety of different subjects, either over the course of the term or at least the year.

It is common for students to fatigue quickly when first beginning written narration. Allow them to initially write a bit and tell the rest. Some may do better by first orally narrating and discussing as usual, then writing a sentence or so of that narration. Others may do better by beginning their narration in writing, then completing orally.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Written narrations can happen at the end of any lesson if time allows and do not need to take up an extra 10 minutes in your schedule. This tracker just serves to remind you to start the habit.



Term 1

WEEK 2 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ DICTATE/DEMONSTRATE

Each lesson after the first will begin with dictation of 1-2 mastered letters. Simply call out a letter that has been mastered and have the child write it from memory on the Penny Gardner lined paper. Then the teacher should model any new strokes or letters properly on a chalkboard while narrating steps.

→ VISUALIZE

The student should visualize the letter and then write it from memory on his or her smaller chalkboard (the drag on the chalk helps them “feel” the stroke).

→ PRACTICE

The student will continue practicing the letter on the chalkboard until mastered from memory. Then, slowly and carefully copy the letter on the single practice line in the lesson.

→ EVALUATE

Allow the student to self-assess before writing another copy of the letter. The student continues copying from memory until able to produce six very good copies in a row.

Only focus on 1-2 letters per day at most, and allow as long as needed for particularly difficult letters or new stroke patterns. Use extra practice paper as needed, but celebrate when able to produce these six copies within the single practice line.

→ COPY

Once students have mastered enough letters, they may use time at the end of their writing lessons to copy words from their reading lesson word lists on their Penny Gardner lesson pages. Just flip back to the first word list and start from there. Students will need gentle reminding to visualize those words as a whole and to write them from memory rather than letter by letter.

Older students may start copying interesting sentences or phrases from poems and books as they are able.

WEEK 2 15m Reading Level 3 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ COMPLETE

Lessons 1.6-2.3 this week

WEEK 2 10m Written Narration: Grade 3 - Lesson 2

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

Complete one written narration this week.

★ TEACHER NOTE

If students have a hard time starting written narrations using their books, try asking them to write about their morning or what they saw on a nature walk.

WEEK 3 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 3 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ DICTATE/DEMONSTRATE

Each lesson after the first will begin with dictation of 1-2 mastered letters. Simply call out a letter that has been mastered and have the child write it from memory on the Penny Gardner lined paper. Then the teacher should model any new strokes or letters properly on a chalkboard while narrating

Term 1	
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WEEK 3 15m Reading Level 3 - Tracker Tracker:	
→ COMPLETE Lessons 2.4-3.2 this week	
WEEK 3 10m Written Narration: Grade 3 - Lesson 3 → WRITTEN NARRATION Complete one written narration this week.	